CHINHOYI UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY · ABF-FST RESEARCH STUDY

Role Guide 4: Questionnaire QA Research Assistant

Step-by-step instructions for the QUAN/Kobo QA RA role in the ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal.

STUDY	Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)
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*Screenshots in this document use **fictional demonstration data**. Organisation and person names, phone numbers and figures shown in them are not real study records.*

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1. Your role at a glance

You make sure every questionnaire counted towards the 400 target is complete, plausible and genuine. The system checks each submission automatically, but nothing passes QA until you (or the Field Coordinator or PI) decide, with a note.

You can

- See the QA Dashboard, QA Queue and QA Exceptions.
- Accept, re-query or reject submissions with a note.
- Assign, work and close QA exceptions.
- Run a KoboToolbox sync.
- Download and email PDFs of completed questionnaires.

You cannot

- See names, contact details or case pages; KII or document records; dashboards other than QA; exports.
- Change answers — corrections are made in KoboToolbox by whoever administered the questionnaire.
- Pass a submission without a note.

> **Where this fits**
> The System Manual explains how the whole system works. This guide covers only what you do, and its last section lists every screen and button you can use, with what each does and why. Ask the Field Coordinator or PI when something is outside your role.

2. Signing in and your screens

Signing in

1. Open **https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login** in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari), on a computer, tablet or phone.
2. Type your **Username** and **Password**, then select **Sign in**.

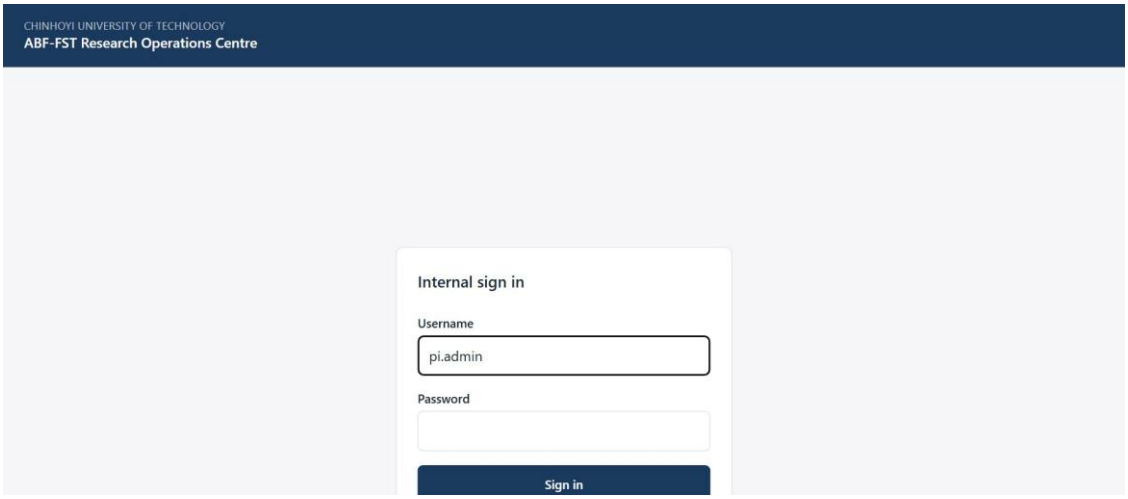


Figure 1. *The sign-in screen for all internal staff.*

3. You arrive on your start screen: **QA Dashboard**. The bar across the top lists only the screens your role (QUAN/Kobo QA RA) can open.

> **Accounts**
> There is no self-registration. The PI / System Admin creates every account and sets its role. Ask the PI if you need an account, a different role, or a password reset.

Finding your way around

- The **top bar** shows your username and role, and the screens you can use. It is not a full menu with some items greyed out: anything absent is simply not part of your role.
- Most screens have a **← Back to …** link at the top that returns you to the screen you came from.
- Registers show **20 rows per page** to begin with. At the foot of the list, **Show** lets you choose 10, 20, 50, 100 or 200 rows per page (the portal remembers your choice), and the page numbers, **Previous**, **Next** and the double arrows take you to any page. The **Search** box above the list narrows it.
- **Change password** (top right) lets you set a new password at any time. Choose a long password you do not use anywhere else.
- **Sign out** (top right) ends your session. Always sign out on a shared or public computer.
- If you are inactive for a while you may be asked to sign in again. This protects research data on unattended devices.

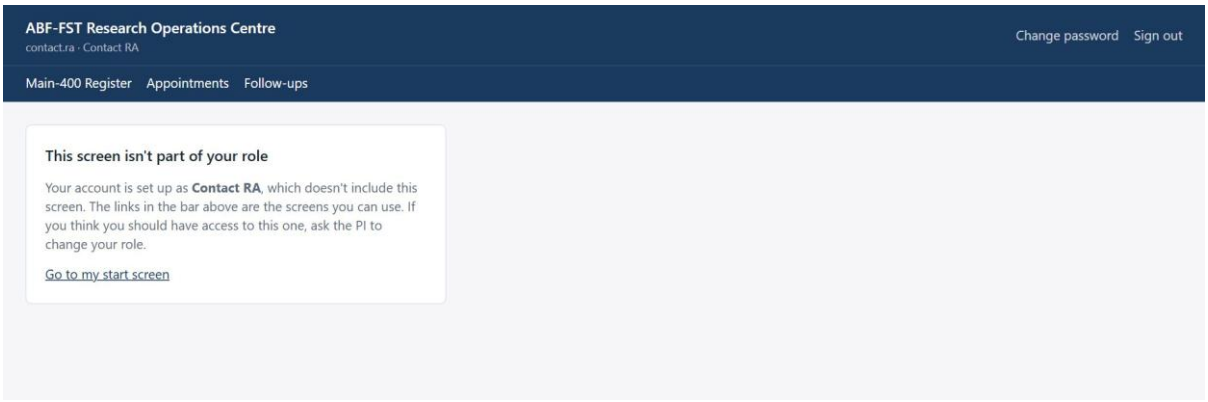


Figure 2. *Opening a screen outside your role (for example from an old bookmark) shows this card instead of the screen.*

Your screens

Screen	What you use it for
QA Dashboard	Submissions today and in total, queue size, decisions, modes.
Form PDFs	Readable copies of completed questionnaires.
QA Queue	Take decisions; run a KoboToolbox sync.
QA Exceptions	Automated flags to investigate and close.

Changing your password

1. Select **Change password** in the top right corner.
2. Enter your **Current password**, then the **New password** twice, and select **Change password**.

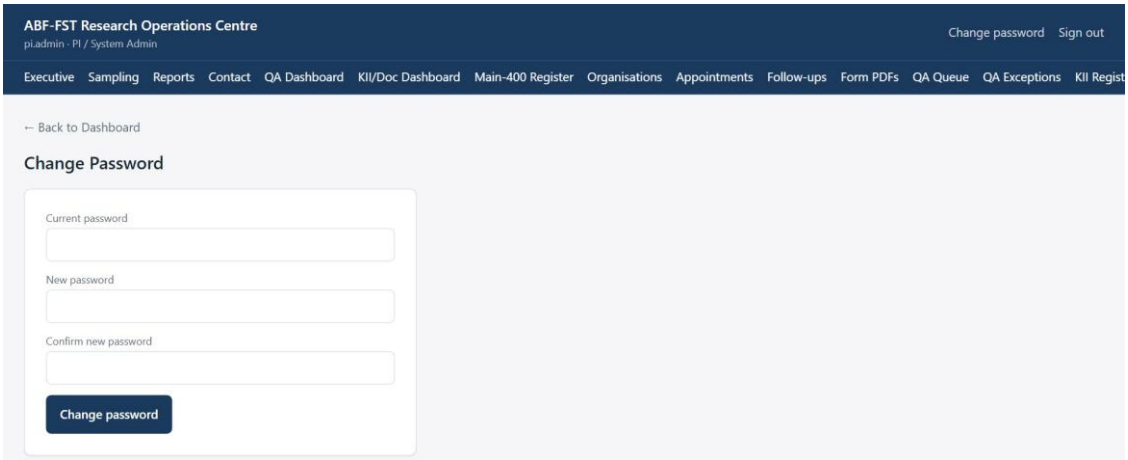


Figure 3. *Change Password screen.*

3. Use the new password next time you sign in. If you have forgotten your password, ask the PI to reset it.

3. Your routine

A suggested rhythm. Adjust it to the Field Coordinator's plan.

When	What to do
Start of day	QA Dashboard: how many are waiting. Sync now on the QA Queue if you expect new submissions.
Main work	Oldest QA exceptions first, then the QA Queue oldest first.
For each submission	Open the PDF, check the rules, decide with a clear note.
End of day	Queue and exceptions no older than two days; report patterns (e.g. many short completions from one mode) to the Field Coordinator.

4. Step-by-step tasks

4.1 Reading the QA Dashboard

1. Select **QA Dashboard**. It shows submissions today and cumulatively, the open queue, decisions recorded, and completions by administration mode (01–06).

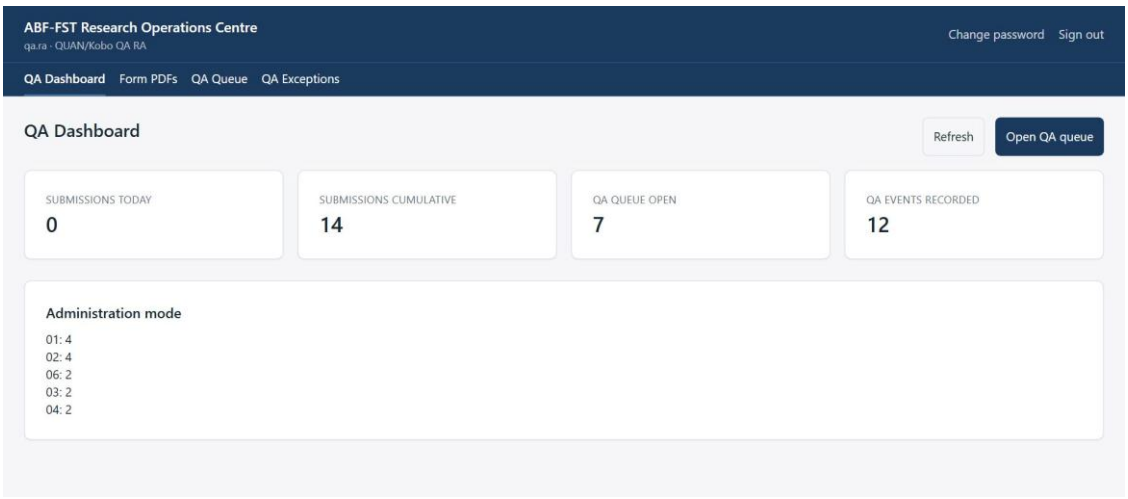


Figure 4. *QA Dashboard.*

2. Select **Refresh** to update the figures, or **Open QA queue** to start work.

4.2 Reviewing questionnaires in the QA Queue

1. Select **QA Queue**. Each submission shows the Sample ID, when it was submitted, the administration mode, the completion time in minutes and its QA status (PENDING or QUERY).

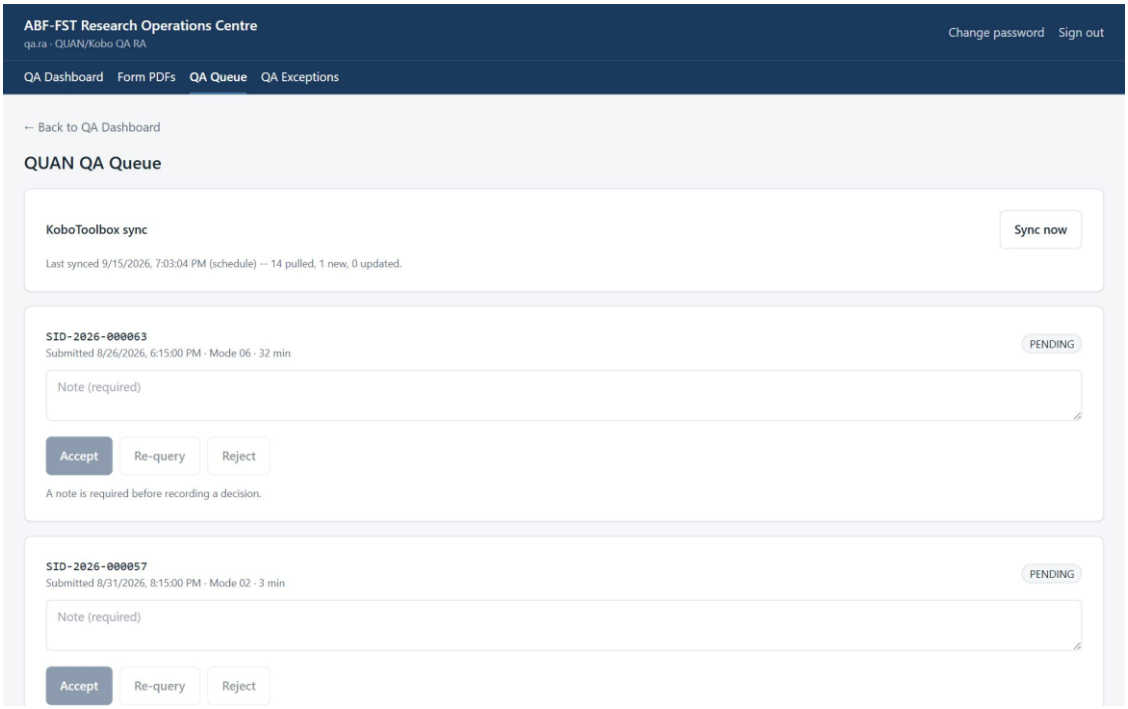


Figure 5. *QUAN QA Queue with the KoboToolbox sync panel.*

2. Open the completed form to check the answers: **Form PDFs → Download PDF**, or the **Completed questionnaire** panel on the case page.
3. Check it against the QA rules (table below) and any open QA exception for that case.
4. Write a **Note (required)** explaining your decision.
5. Select **Accept** (moves the case to S10 QA passed), **Re-query** (S09 QA query — follow up with the respondent or the RA who administered it) or **Reject** (not usable).

Rule	Setting	Effect
Required answers missing	65 required fields from the live questionnaire	Hard stop: raises an exception; cannot pass without a human decision and note.
Too quick	Completed in under 5 minutes (300 s)	Soft flag for review.
Too slow	Completed in over 90 minutes (5400 s)	Soft flag for review.
Possible duplicate	Another submission for the same organisation within 24 hours	Soft flag for review.

> **Nothing passes automatically**
> Even a submission with no flags needs a person to select Accept. Every decision and its note is audited.

Pulling new submissions now

Submissions arrive within seconds (KoboToolbox notifies the portal) and a full check runs every 15 minutes between 06:00 and 22:00 and hourly overnight. To check immediately, select **Sync now** in **KoboToolbox sync**; the panel shows the last run, how many were pulled and how many were new or updated. An edited submission returns to the queue for review.

4.3 Working QA exceptions

1. Select **QA Exceptions**. Each card shows the rule that fired (for example `hard_stop_missing_required_fields` or `min_plausible_duration_seconds`), the Sample ID, when it was raised and its status. Oldest first.

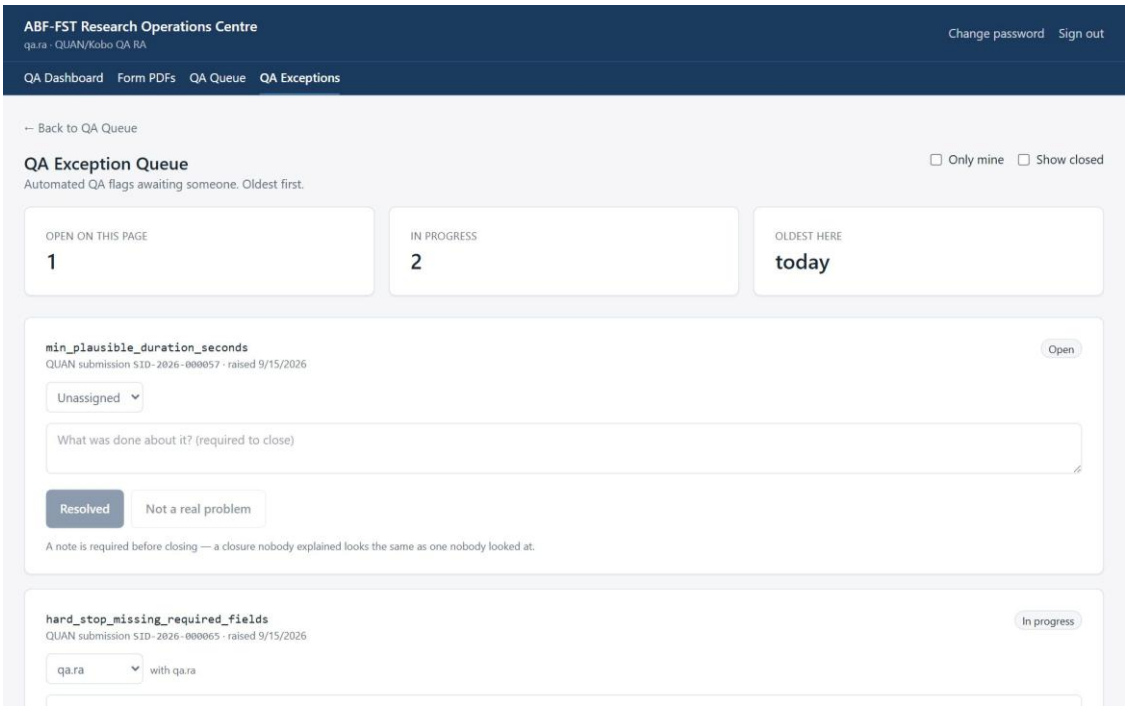


Figure 6. *QA Exception Queue.*

2. Tick **Only mine** to see exceptions assigned to you; tick **Show closed** to include resolved ones.
3. Use **Assign to** to take ownership (or give it to a colleague). The status becomes **In progress**.
4. Investigate: open the form PDF, check the case timeline, contact the respondent if needed.
5. Type **What was done about it?** and select **Resolved**, or **Not a real problem** if the flag was a false alarm. A note is always required.

4.4 Downloading or emailing completed forms (Form PDFs)

1. Select **Form PDFs**. You see the completed questionnaire forms from KoboToolbox, newest first, 20 per page to begin with (choose more under **Show** at the foot of the list).

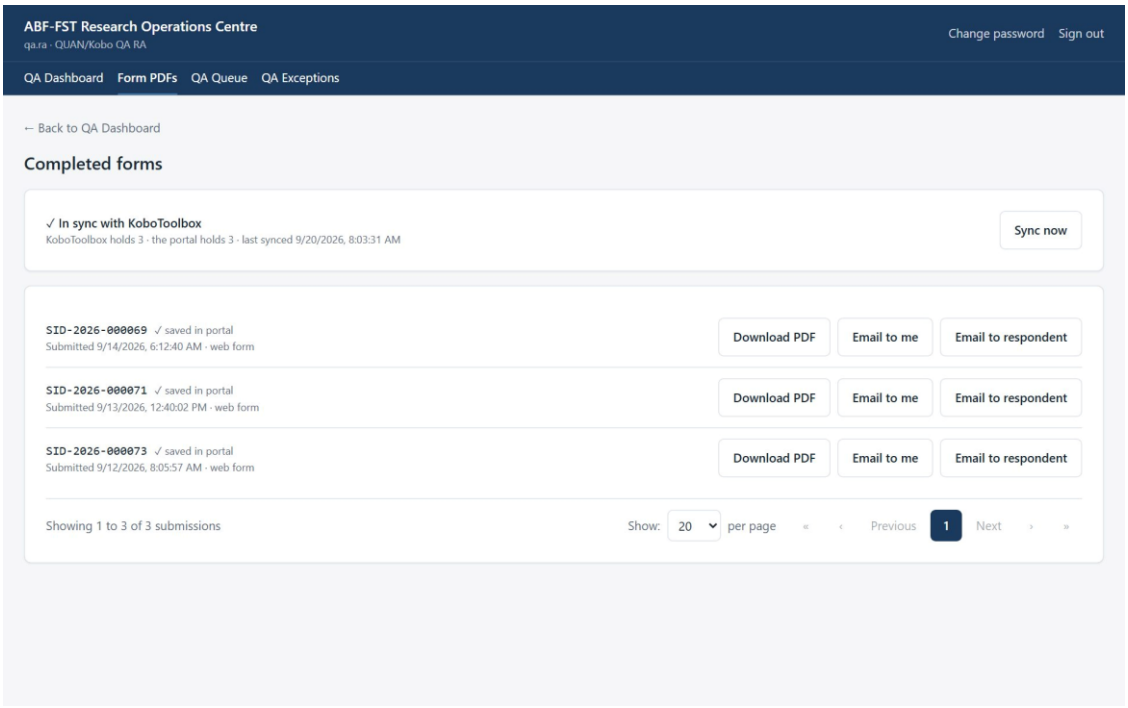


Figure 7. *Completed form PDFs.*

2. Select **Download PDF** to save a readable copy: sections, questions, the chosen answers as words (not codes) and repeated groups.
3. Select **Email to me** to send the PDF to the email address on your account.
4. For the questionnaire only, select **Email to respondent** to send the respondent a copy of their own answers at the email address recorded on the case (only while their consent stands). You are asked to confirm first. Every email is audited with the address masked.

At the top of the page, a sync panel shows whether the portal holds the same forms as KoboToolbox, for example "✓ In sync with KoboToolbox — KoboToolbox holds 12 · the portal holds 12". Each row also says "✓ saved in portal" once the portal has an identical copy. If the panel says "Not in sync", select **Sync now** (read-only roles see the panel but not the button); it takes a few seconds.

The same PDF is available from the record itself: the case page (questionnaire), the KII page (KII Guide) or the document page (coding form).

> **How the sync works**
> The portal keeps its own copy of the questionnaire, KII Guide and Document Analysis Tool, and refreshes it every 15 minutes and whenever someone selects Sync now. A submission edited in KoboToolbox is updated here; one deleted in KoboToolbox is flagged as removed. You never need to sync before downloading a PDF: the PDF is always read from KoboToolbox at that moment.

4.5 Writing good QA notes

- State what you checked and what you found: "Duration 3 min; answers straight-lined in Sections 4–6; re-queried with RA".
- For Accept: "All required answers present; duration 28 min plausible; no duplicate".
- For Re-query: say exactly what needs confirming or completing.
- Never include personal opinions about the respondent.

5. Rules you must follow

- Decide on evidence, not on who the organisation is.
- Never download PDFs to personal devices or share them outside the team.
- Treat everything in the portal as **confidential research data**. Do not screenshot, copy, print or forward names, phone numbers, email addresses or answers except as your role requires.
- Never share your username or password, and never sign in for someone else.
- Use the respondent's contact details **only** to manage their participation in this study (invitations, reminders, appointments).
- Never tell a respondent, lender or anyone else that answers affect financing. The study generates **no score, rating or financing decision**.
- If a respondent asks to withdraw, stop contacting them and tell the Field Coordinator or PI the same day so the withdrawal is recorded.
- Report a lost device, a suspected account compromise, or data sent to the wrong person to the PI immediately.

6. Troubleshooting

Situation	Likely cause	What to do
Accept / Re-query / Reject are greyed out	No note written yet.	Type the note first.
Accept is refused: “Reconcile the pre-interview profile first…”	The case has a locked pre-interview profile with facts not yet verified with the respondent or not reconciled.	Ask the Field Coordinator to finish verification and reconciliation on the case's Interview sheet. Re-query and Reject are never blocked.
A submission I expected is not in the queue	It has not been pulled yet, or it was set aside (not launched from the portal).	Select Sync now; if still missing, tell the Field Coordinator.
"This screen isn't part of your role"	The screen belongs to another role (often an old bookmark or shared link).	Select Go to my start screen. If you need that screen, ask the PI about your role.
"Too many sign-in attempts from this network"	Sign-in is rate-limited per network; an office shares one address.	Wait a minute and try again. A wrong password says so explicitly.
A register shows fewer rows than expected	Registers show 20 rows per page to begin with; a Contact RA sees only assigned cases.	Choose more rows under Show at the foot of the list, use the page numbers or Next, or search. Ask the Field Coordinator to assign the case.
A button is greyed out	A required step is missing (a note, an authenticity decision, a selection).	Read the message beside the button; complete the missing step first.
"KoboToolbox couldn't be reached"	KoboToolbox is slow or the connection token has changed.	Try again in a few minutes. If it persists, tell the PI.
Form PDFs says "Not in sync with KoboToolbox yet"	The counts differ: a form was submitted or changed in KoboToolbox since the last sync (it runs every 15 minutes).	Select Sync now. If it still differs, or says it couldn't reach KoboToolbox, try again in a few minutes and tell the PI if it persists.
A document says "Already submitted" and its answers are locked	Its coding was already sent to KoboToolbox; changing it here would not change that record.	To redo the coding, delete that record in KoboToolbox, then select Sync now on Form PDFs. The document unlocks.
A page keeps loading	A slow or dropped connection.	Refresh the page. Your saved work is not lost; unsaved typing may be.
Send invitations says email isn't set up	Outgoing email has not been configured on the server.	Ask the administrator to run `configure-email.sh`. Until then, send invitations by WhatsApp.
Send invitations says SMS or WhatsApp isn't set up	Twilio has not been configured on the server, or (WhatsApp) Meta has not approved the sender and templates yet.	Ask the administrator to run `configure-twilio.sh`. Until then, send by email, or by hand from the study WhatsApp number.
A WhatsApp invitation was prepared but never sent	Prepare counts it as sent and moves the case to S05.	Open the case and Revoke that invitation; send a new one from the case's Invitations panel when you can reach the person.

Situation	Likely cause	What to do
A case is missing from the WhatsApp or email queue	It is not verified (S03 or S04), has no number or email on file, already has an open invitation, or is assigned to another Contact RA.	Verify the case, add the contact detail, or check its invitation history.
The contact finder says it would overwrite a detail	The organisation contact already has a different phone or email.	Check which is right and correct it under Respondents and contact details.
A file upload seems stuck	A large file on a slow connection takes time; the bar shows how much has been sent.	Wait for Saving… and the file name. If it fails, try again or upload a smaller version.

7. Quick reference

Sign in	https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login
You start on	QA Dashboard
Duration limits	5 to 90 minutes
Duplicate window	24 hours
Required fields	65 from the live questionnaire
Help	Field Coordinator; PI: Happyson Saina, 0773943709, abffst.research@gmail.com

8. Every screen and button for your role

This section lists every screen you can open as QUAN/Kobo QA RA, and for each control: what it does and when to use it, why it exists (the rule behind it), and what you will see next. It is the same material as the Screen and Button Reference, cut down to your role.

> **Reading the tables**
> **Control** is the label you see on screen. **Why it exists** explains the rule or risk behind it; if a button is greyed out, this column usually says why. A control that needs a note or a confirmation says so.

8.1 Sign in

Who can open it: every role. **Where:** `/admin/login`

Where every staff member starts. Staff accounts are created by the PI; there is no self-registration.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Username	Type the username the PI gave you.	Every action in the portal is recorded against a named person, so accounts are never shared.	Nothing yet; you also need the password.
Password	Type your password. The characters are hidden.	Passwords are never shown or emailed; the PI can reset yours but cannot read it.	Nothing yet; select Sign in.
Sign in	Checks your username and password and opens your start screen (the first screen your role uses).	Repeated wrong attempts from one network are refused for a minute, to stop password guessing.	Your start screen opens. A wrong password says so. “Too many sign-in attempts” means wait a minute.

8.2 The header and menu bar (every screen)

Who can open it: every role. **Where:** `(top of every screen)`

Shown at the top of every signed-in screen. The menu bar lists only the screens your role may open.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Menu bar (Executive, Sampling, … Audit)	Opens a screen. The current screen is underlined.	The list is built by the server from your role, so you never see a screen that would refuse you.	The screen opens. A screen not in your list shows “This screen isn't part of your role”.
Change password	Opens the Change Password screen.	You should change the first password you were given, and any password you think someone saw.	The Change Password screen opens.
Sign out	Ends your session on this device.	Protects the data if the device is shared or lost. Always sign out on a shared device.	Your session on this device ends and you return to the Sign in screen.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
← Back to … (top left)	Returns to the parent screen (for example from a case to the register).	A consistent way back that does not lose your place in the menu.	The parent screen opens.
Go to my start screen	Appears on the “This screen isn't part of your role” page and takes you to your own start screen.	An old bookmark or shared link may point at a screen that belongs to another role; this gets you out safely.	Your start screen opens.

8.3 Change Password

Who can open it: every role. **Where:** `/admin/account`

Change your own password.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Current password	Type the password you use now.	Proves it is really you before a change, in case a signed-in device was left open.	Nothing yet.
New password	Type the new password.	It must be long enough, not a common password, not all digits and not similar to your username or name; the screen says which rule failed.	Nothing yet.
Confirm new password	Type the new password again.	Catches a typing slip that would lock you out.	Nothing yet.
Change password	Saves the new password.	Your old password stops working straight away, and other people (including the PI) never see your new one.	A confirmation appears. Use the new password next time.

8.4 QA Dashboard

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, QUAN/Kobo QA RA, Supervisor. **Where:** `/admin/dashboard/qa`

Quality checking at a glance: how many questionnaires wait for a decision and how the completed ones were done.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Refresh	Re-reads the figures now.	The page does not update by itself while you watch it.	The numbers reload; the button says Refreshing… briefly.
Administration mode	Shows how many questionnaires were completed by each mode (web, telephone, WhatsApp-assisted, face to face).	Mode balance is a quality and method question for the study.	Read only.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Open QA queue	Goes to the QA Queue.	Takes you from the overview to the work.	The QA Queue opens.
Try again	Appears if the figures could not load; tries once more.	A dropped connection should not leave a blank page.	The figures load, or the message stays.

8.5 QA Queue (with the KoboToolbox sync panel)

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, QUAN/Kobo QA RA, Supervisor. **Where:** `/admin/qa`

Every completed questionnaire waits here for a human quality decision. Nothing is ever passed automatically.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
KoboToolbox sync → Sync now	Pulls completed questionnaires from KoboToolbox right now, instead of waiting for the automatic check (every 15 minutes).	KoboToolbox is where the questionnaire is answered; the portal has to fetch what was submitted. A new or edited submission enters the queue when it is fetched.	A summary shows how many were new or changed. “Not connected” or “Last sync failed” explains a problem; the automatic check keeps trying.
Note (required)	Write what you checked and found (for example “duration 28 min plausible, no duplicate”).	A decision nobody explained looks the same as one nobody made; the note is what a later reviewer relies on.	The decision buttons stay off until there is a note.
Accept	Records that the submission passed quality checking.	Only a person can pass a questionnaire; even one that triggered no rule is not passed until someone accepts it. If the case has a locked pre-interview profile, every fact on it must first be verified with the respondent and reconciled (or a deviation recorded).	The submission is marked QA passed, the case moves on, and the decision is audited. If the profile is not reconciled you are told how many facts are outstanding, and nothing changes.
Re-query	Sends the submission back with a question about what needs confirming or fixing.	Some problems (an odd answer, a very short time) need the respondent or interviewer to clarify before a decision.	The submission is marked as queried and the case moves to “QA query”. If the answers are edited in KoboToolbox, the next sync puts it back in the queue.
Reject	Records that the submission fails and will not be used.	Fabricated, duplicate or unusable data must be kept out of the analysis, but never silently deleted.	The submission is marked rejected. It is kept and the decision and your note are audited.

8.6 QA Exceptions

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, QUAN/Kobo QA RA, Supervisor. **Where:** `/admin/qa/exceptions`

Flags the automatic quality rules raised (for example a very short completion time). Each waits for someone to deal with it and explain what was done.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Only mine	Shows just the exceptions assigned to you.	Lets each QA person work their own list.	The list narrows and returns to page 1.
Include resolved	Also shows exceptions that were already closed.	Useful for checking what was done before, or how similar flags were handled.	Closed exceptions appear with who closed them, when and why.
Assign to	Chooses who deals with the exception, or Unassigned.	So each flag has an owner and none is left for “someone”.	The exception appears in that person's “Only mine” list.
What was done about it? (required to close)	Write what you did (what you checked, who you contacted).	A closure nobody explained looks the same as one nobody looked at.	The two closing buttons stay off until there is a note.
Resolved	Closes the exception because you dealt with a real problem.	Distinguishes “there was a problem and it was fixed” from a false alarm, so rules can be tuned.	The exception is closed with your name, the time and your note.
Not a real problem	Closes the exception because the flag was a false alarm.	False alarms are information too: many of them means a rule threshold may be wrong.	The exception is closed as dismissed, with your note.

8.7 Completed forms (Form PDFs)

Who can open it: PI / System Admin, Field / Digital Coordinator, QUAN/Kobo QA RA, KII RA, Documentary RA, Supervisor. **Where:** `/admin/submissions`

The completed KoboToolbox forms for your role (the questionnaire, the KII Guide or the Document Analysis Tool; the PI, coordinator and supervisor can switch between all three).

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
Sync panel: “In sync with KoboToolbox”	Shows how many submissions KoboToolbox holds and how many the portal holds, and when they were last matched.	The portal keeps its own copy of the completed forms. If the two numbers differ, the portal is behind.	Read only. “Not in sync” means press Sync now.
Sync now	Pulls that form from KoboToolbox now and updates the portal's copy.	The automatic sync runs every 15 minutes; this brings it up to date immediately. It also notices edits and deletions made in KoboToolbox.	The counts refresh. A KII record's coding can move to COMPLETE; a document whose submission was deleted in KoboToolbox unlocks.

Control	What it does and when to use it	Why it exists	What happens next
✓ saved in portal (on each row)	Says the portal holds an identical copy of that submission.	Proof, row by row, that nothing was lost or changed between KoboToolbox and the portal.	Read only. It is missing until the next sync for a new or edited row.
Download PDF	Downloads that completed form as a readable PDF (sections, questions, answers as words).	A readable copy for records, meetings and checking.	A PDF downloads; the download is audited.
Email to me	Emails that PDF to the address on your own account.	A PDF is a full research record, so it goes only to you, never to a typed-in address.	“Sent to …” (address masked). Recorded in the audit log.
Email to respondent (questionnaire only)	Emails the respondent a copy of their own answers, at the address on their case, after you confirm.	Respondents may ask for their answers; the copy goes only to the address on file and only while their consent stands.	A confirmation first; then “Sent to …”. Refused if consent was withdrawn or no email is on file.
Show / page numbers	Choose rows per page and move between pages.	As on every register.	The list redraws.